

INSTRUCTIONS FOR ESSAY EXAMINATION

1. Answer all five (5) essay questions provided. Each response must demonstrate advanced critical analysis, synthesis of ideas, and application of legal and governance principles.
2. Format Requirements:
 - Paper Size: A4
 - Font Style: Cambria
 - Font Size: 12
 - Line Spacing: 1.5
 - Margin: 1 inch on all sides
3. On the right side of the paper, write the following information:
 - Name
 - Course
 - Subject
 - Date
4. Compile your answers in printed form and secure them using a paper clip (do not staple).
5. Ensure that your work is original. Proper citation must be observed when referencing sources.
6. Due Date: April 28, 2026
7. Submit a soft copy of your work in Microsoft Word format (.doc or .docx). PDF format is not allowed.

Question 1: Institutional Independence and Accountability

Critically evaluate the constitutional design of the Constitutional Commissions under Article IX (i.e., the Commission on Elections, Commission on Audit, and Civil Service Commission) in ensuring independence from political interference.

- To what extent does this independence strengthen democratic governance?
- Analyze potential tensions between independence and accountability mechanisms.
- Support your argument with theoretical frameworks in public administration and constitutional law.

Question 2: Decentralization vs. National Control

Article X promotes local autonomy. Examine the extent to which decentralization in the Philippines truly empowers local government units (LGUs).

- Assess whether national government oversight undermines or enhances local autonomy.
- Use case-based reasoning to analyze the balance between decentralization and national integrity.
- Integrate governance theories such as subsidiarity and multi-level governance.

Question 3: Electoral Integrity and Democratic Stability

Discuss the role of the Commission on Elections in safeguarding electoral integrity under Article IX.

- Evaluate its effectiveness in addressing electoral fraud, political dynasties, and voter disenfranchisement.
- Propose institutional reforms grounded in comparative electoral systems.
- Analyze how electoral credibility affects political legitimacy and democratic stability.

Question 4: Fiscal Accountability and Local Governance

Analyze the interaction between Article IX (through the Commission on Audit) and Article X (local fiscal autonomy).

- How does audit oversight influence LGU performance and accountability?
- Discuss the challenges of ensuring transparency while respecting local autonomy.
- Provide a critical assessment of fiscal decentralization in practice.

Question 5: Bureaucratic Professionalism and Local Administration

Evaluate the role of the Civil Service Commission in maintaining meritocracy within decentralized governance structures under Article X.

- How does the civil service system affect efficiency and corruption at the local level?
- Examine the tensions between political appointments and bureaucratic neutrality.
- Propose policy innovations to strengthen professional public administration in LGUs.